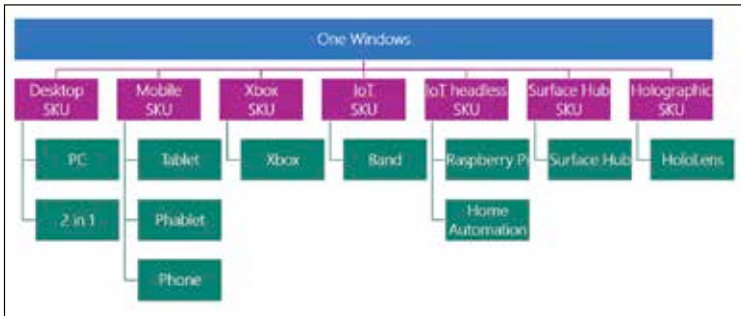




Microsoft intends to share the same core OS across as many hardware platforms as possible so that developers have an easier target.

dows CE for instance was Microsoft's OS for handheld devices and other consumer electronics. It is what powered mobile versions of Windows, such as Windows Mobile and later Windows Phone. Another historic merging came with Windows 8 and Windows Phone 8, which both used the same Windows NT core. With Windows 8.1 they got even closer. Another device that joined the Windows family was the Xbox One, which now runs a Windows NT kernel.

Microsoft earlier was using different OS core for Xbox 360, another for their Mobile devices and another for their desktops. Now all their devices are part of the Windows family and the Windows ecosystem.

With Windows 10 Microsoft has converged the Windows 10 family even tighter. As the Windows ecosystem expands to include new kinds of devices such as the Xbox One, the Raspberry Pi 2, and soon the HoloLens, the common bits of code that Windows is running on these devices has now expanded.

Microsoft has identified the core bits of functionality that any device running Windows should have and has made them part of what it calls the Windows Core. This is more than just the NT kernel, it includes common functionality such as support for input and output devices, that is common for all platforms.

The Universal Windows Platform

This is what Microsoft calls its Universal Windows Platform. It is the core functionality that developers can expect to find on any Windows device. This is something developers can rely on when making Windows apps. An app